

# Field Capture — Training Guide

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For picking teams logging crates at a field station.

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## The 5-step loop

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This is everything you'll do, over and over, all day:

1. **Tap "Scan Worker QR"** and point the camera at the worker's badge.
2. **Choose the block** from the dropdown, if it isn't already selected.
3. **Type the weight** on the keypad.
4. **Tap "Save Crate."** You'll hear a chime and the crate count at the top of the screen goes up.
5. Repeat for the next crate.

When a truck is ready to take a load away, you send a **Picking Slip** (see below) — that's the only other thing you'll do.

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## Your screen, top to bottom

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- **Top bar** — shows which station this device is, and whether it's connected (**Offline**, **Syncing...**, or **Online - synced**). Don't worry if it says Offline — see "Working without signal" below.
- **Crates / kg card** — how many crates and total kg logged for the load currently being built at this station, plus how long it's been running.
- **Scan Worker QR button** — tap this before every crate.
- **Block** — which block this crate came from.
- **Weight keypad** — type the number, then tap the crate icon (delete button clears a mistyped digit).
- **Save Crate** — logs the crate. Do this every single time, even if you're in a rush — a crate that isn't saved doesn't count.
- **Send Picking Slip** — only tap this when a truck is actually leaving with the load.

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## Logging a crate, step by step

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**1. Scan the worker's badge.** Tap **Scan Worker QR**. Point the camera steadily at the worker's printed badge until it beeps. The worker's name appears on screen once it's matched — check it's the right person before continuing.

If it says "**QR code doesn't match a known worker**," that badge isn't recognized. Don't guess — tell your supervisor so the office can check or reprint it. There's no way to type a worker in manually; it has to be a scan.

If it says "**Camera unavailable**," see "If something looks wrong" at the end of this guide — it's usually a quick fix you can do yourself.

**2. Check the block.** Make sure the block dropdown shows the block you're actually picking in. It usually stays the same all day at one station, but double-check it after a break or when moving to a new area.

**3. Weigh and enter the crate's weight.** Use the on-screen keypad. The "." button is for decimals (e.g. 18.5 ), and the delete button (<ⓧ) removes the last digit if you make a mistake.

**4. Save the crate.** Tap **Save Crate**. You'll hear a short chime and the crate count updates immediately. That's your confirmation it was logged — if you don't hear the chime or see the count change, try again.

**5. Repeat.** Scan the next worker for the next crate. You don't need to reselect the block unless it's changed.

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## Sending a Picking Slip (when the truck arrives)

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When a truck is ready to take crates to the pack house:

1. Tap **Send Picking Slip**.
2. Enter how many crates are going **right now** — if the truck can't take everything you've logged, you can send fewer and keep the rest for the next truck (see "Splitting a load" below).
3. Enter the **driver's name**.
4. Tap **Send**.

A green "**Picking Slip Sent**" banner confirms it went through, and you'll see it added to "Dispatched today from this station" further down the screen.

## Splitting a load

If you have more crates logged than the truck can carry, you can send just some of them — enter that smaller number of "crates going now" instead of the full count. This needs the device to actually be connected (not offline) at that moment, since the office's system has to work out exactly which crates are going. If you see a message about reconnecting to split the load, either wait a moment for the connection to come back, or send everything on this truck instead.

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## Working without signal

Out in the field, this device is often out of Wi-Fi/data range — that's completely normal and nothing breaks. Every crate you save is stored on the device itself first. As soon as the device gets a connection again (even briefly), everything you logged sends itself to the office automatically — you don't need to do anything.

The status at the top just tells you what's happening:

| Status                         | What it means                                                                                         |
|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Offline                        | No connection right now — crates are still saving locally, nothing is lost.                           |
| Syncing...                     | Connection found, sending your logged crates now.                                                     |
| Online - synced                | Everything is up to date with the office.                                                             |
| Online - sync failed, retrying | Connected, but couldn't reach the office system yet — it'll keep trying on its own every few seconds. |

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## Checking your own work

- **Recent crates** (lower on the screen) shows the last few crates you logged, so you can double-check nothing was missed.
- **Dispatched today from this station** shows every picking slip already sent today, with totals.

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## If something looks wrong

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- **"Camera unavailable" when scanning, or the status won't move past "Offline" even though the phone has signal?** Check that **Tailscale** is running:

1. Open the **Tailscale** app on the phone (it's separate from this app, usually its own icon on the home screen).
2. It should say **"Connected."** If it says "Not connected" or similar, tap to reconnect, or sign in again if it asks you to.
3. Go back to this app and try again.

This device needs Tailscale connected to reach the office system at all — without it, the camera scanner won't work and nothing will sync, even with full signal. If Tailscale shows Connected and it's still not working, that's one for your supervisor.

- **Logged the wrong weight or wrong worker on a crate that's already saved?** You can't fix this from the field device — tell your supervisor so the office can correct it.
- **Screen looks different / missing a button?** The app may need updating — tell your supervisor, don't try to fix it yourself.
- **Nothing happens when you tap Save Crate?** Make sure a weight is entered and a worker is selected first — both are needed before it'll save.